

10.1.2 FreeCol

FreeCol is for all the strategy buffs out there. It is basically the open source version of *Colonization* (which is essentially based on *Civilization*). FreeCol is almost a direct clone of the *Colonization* game, and is pretty good time-pass on long office days.



F1 on mud? Now that's what we call entertainment!

The player's objective in FreeCol is to colonise America. You start off with one ship (a Caravel) and two colonists. You have to find a new land and colonise it. Once you find the land, your colonists have to build a colony which you will need to grow and develop. Eventually, your colony has to be able to declare independence and survive an attack of the King's forces. Simple, no? Not quite. In the process, you will have to take into account a variety of factors like the native Americans, the other Europeans who are also busy colonising and getting the majority of people in your colony behind you before declaring independence. It all adds up to hours of interesting gameplay.

At first play the game may seem a bit slow. Turns happen at the end of every year, and if you don't have many ships, colonists, etc. you hardly get any turns: each character—be it a ship or an individual—gets a certain number of turns that it is allowed every year. However, once the game progresses and you've got some sort of a hang of it, you'll wonder why the hell they give you so many turns! The game also allows multiplayer gaming online. It really gets interesting when you open up the map and see the progress of the other Europeans. You will need a lot of Free Colonists. Spread your colonies to better your chances: you'll need to buy more ships by